

Getting Ready for Your Fourth Guided AI Session

A short guide to read before you begin

This guide explains what will happen in your fourth session with the AI assistant. Reading it first means you'll know what to expect, why the session is shaped the way it is, and how to get the most out of it. It takes just a few minutes to read.

Welcome back — from your own mind to the space between two people

In your first session, you looked at how the mind works moment to moment: a situation sparks an automatic thought, the thought stirs an emotion, the emotion shapes what you do and how your body reacts — and it all loops back on itself. In your second session, you stepped back and mapped the bigger picture — the problems you'd most like to be free from, and the goals you'd like to move toward. In your third, you took one real, distressing thought and examined it slowly and fairly with the Intrapersonal Thought Record, or Intra-TR.

This session takes that same idea and extends it to two people. Most of what troubles us happens in the space between us and someone else — a partner, a family member, a colleague, a friend, or sometimes people whose reaction we're simply unsure of. You'll take one real situation between you and another person and follow it through a tool called the Interpersonal Thought Record, or Inter-TR. The aim is to see how your thoughts, feelings, and behaviour and the other person's thoughts, feelings, and behaviour fit together into a single pattern — and to find the part of that pattern you can most change.

Good to know: There are no right or wrong answers here, and nothing you say is being graded. The Inter-TR simply helps you see an exchange between two people more clearly — the way you might step back from a dance to notice the steps you're both making.

What this session is

You'll work through the Inter-TR with the AI guide — a set of ten plain questions that carry one real situation from “here's what happened between us” all the way to “here's what I'll try next.” It builds directly on the Intra-TR you used last time: the very same kind of cycle you traced in yourself, now followed between you and another person. At the end, you'll turn what you notice into a short, practical Action Plan.

The ten questions and a picture of the Inter-TR are printed in the **Annex** at the end of this guide, so you can see the whole path before you start.

Who you'll be talking to

As before, you'll be chatting with an AI assistant set up to guide this one exercise — a friendly companion for this particular step. A few things to keep in mind:

- It is **not a replacement** for your therapist or doctor. It's guiding one exercise, not managing your overall care.
- It won't take sides, judge the other person, or tell you who was right. Its job is to help you see the whole pattern, not to assign blame.
- It stays gently focused on this exercise. If you raise something else, it will kindly keep to the task and suggest saving that for your therapist.

How the session will flow

The session moves through the ten questions in order, at an unhurried pace. You don't need to memorise them — the guide leads the way — but here's the shape, so nothing feels out of the blue.

Here is the whole Inter-TR you'll be working from. Don't worry about taking it all in now — the guide will build it up with you, one box at a time:

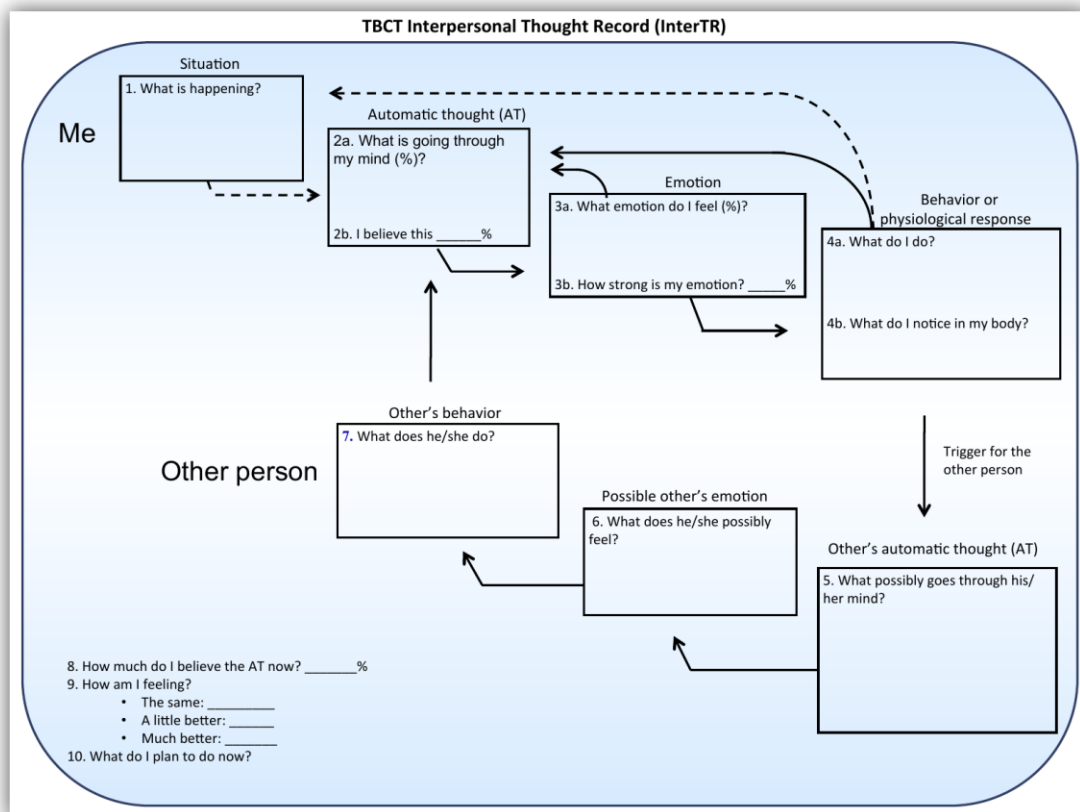


Fig. A7. TBCT Interpersonal Thought Record (Inter-TR).

Fig. A7. The TBCT Interpersonal Thought Record (Inter-TR). Copyright: Irismar Reis de Oliveira; trial-basedcognitivetherapy.com.

Part 1 — Your side of the moment

You'll begin by naming a specific situation between you and another person — something that happened, or often happens. It might be a disagreement, a moment of feeling unheard or let down, a silence that settled between you, or a time you weren't sure how you'd be seen. Then, just as in the Intra-TR, you'll notice the automatic thought that came up and how much you believed it, the emotion it stirred and how strong it was, what you did, and what you noticed in your body.

Part 2 — The other person's side

Next, the guide gently turns to the other person. You'll imagine what might have gone through their mind when they saw how you behaved, what they might have felt, and what they might have done in return.

You're not reading minds. You're not expected to know for certain what the other person thought or felt — none of us can read minds. The guide will simply ask you to picture a plausible possibility. Even a rough guess is enough to make the pattern visible.

Part 3 — Seeing the cycle

This is the heart of the session. With both sides laid out, the guide will help you step back and look at the whole exchange as a single, circular pattern: your thought leads to your feeling, which shapes your behaviour, which influences what the other person thinks, feels, and does — which then loops back and feeds your side all over again. Rather than explaining this to you, the guide will ask what you notice, so the recognition is your own. Because you already met this looping idea in the Intra-TR, it often clicks quickly here — it's the same cycle, now shared between two people.

Part 4 — Finding the part you can change

Once the cycle is clear, the guide will help you sort what's within your reach from what isn't. You can't directly control what the other person thinks, feels, or does — and you can't fully control your own emotions either. But your own behaviour is the one part of the cycle you have real leverage over. That recognition is what makes the next step meaningful.

Part 5 — Your Action Plan

Finally, you'll turn that insight into a plan. You'll decide what you might do differently, list the specific actions, think through what could get in the way of each one, work out how you'd handle those obstacles, and choose when you'll try. You'll build it on the form below:

Action Plan: _____

Proposed actions:

a. _____

b. _____

c. _____

d. _____

Possible obstacles to actions:

a. _____

b. _____

c. _____

d. _____

Solutions to obstacles:

a. _____

b. _____

c. _____

d. _____

When to implement proposed actions:

a. _____

b. _____

c. _____

d. _____

Follow-up:

a. _____

b. _____

c. _____

d. _____

Fig. A10. Action Plan

Fig. A10. The Action Plan. Copyright: Irismar Reis de Oliveira; trial-basedcognitivetherapy.com.

What the conversation will feel like

- **Lots of questions.** The guide leads mostly by asking, not lecturing. This is on purpose — the insights land better when they're yours.
- **One step at a time.** You'll answer one question before moving to the next, so nothing piles up.
- **Unhurried.** There's no clock, and no need to have polished answers ready.
- **Okay to be unsure.** Especially when imagining the other person's side — a best guess is all that's needed. If a question feels hard, just say so, and the guide will slow down or try another angle.
- **Conversational.** It's meant to feel like talking with a knowledgeable friend, not filling in a form.

What to have ready before you start

1. **The Inter-TR worksheet.** The ten questions and a picture of the cycle are printed in the Annex — have it open or nearby. The guide will check you have it before you begin.

2. **A real but manageable situation with another person.** Something that genuinely bothered you — real, but not the most painful thing you can think of. A moderate, everyday example works best for learning the method.
3. **Someone specific in mind.** It helps if the situation involves one identifiable person and one particular moment, rather than a vague or general worry.
4. **A quiet moment.** Set aside a stretch of uninterrupted time where you can focus and reply thoughtfully.
5. **An open, curious frame of mind.** You're here to understand a pattern between two people — not to decide who was to blame.

A few tips to get the most from it

- Answer honestly — the exercise only reflects back what you put into it.
- When you imagine the other person's thoughts and feelings, you don't have to be right. A plausible guess is enough to reveal the cycle.
- Look for how the two of you keep the pattern going together, rather than for who started it. The point isn't fault; it's the shape of the loop.
- When it comes to the Action Plan, aim it at the one part you can actually change — your own behaviour — not at getting the other person to react differently.
- Afterwards, keep your finished Inter-TR and, if you can, share it with your therapist at your next appointment.

What this session is not

So there are no surprises, here's what the AI **won't** do:

- It won't diagnose you or manage your treatment.
- It won't provide crisis support or emergency care.
- It won't take sides or tell you what the other person "really" meant — those judgements aren't its to make.
- It won't push you toward other techniques; it stays within this one exercise.

If you're in distress This session is a learning exercise, not an emergency service. If at any point you feel overwhelmed, or you have thoughts of harming yourself, please pause and reach out to your study clinician or your local emergency services right away. Your safety matters more than finishing the exercise.

You don't need to prepare anything else — the AI will guide you step by step. When you're ready, begin whenever you like.

Annex

Your Inter-TR Worksheet

Keep this nearby during your session. These are the ten questions your guide will walk you through, in order — read them over beforehand so the path feels familiar. The Inter-TR form and the Action Plan form are shown earlier in this guide, and the guide will also display them on screen as you work.

Where it fits	What the guide will ask
Situation	1. What is happening? (Describe it as though it were happening right now.)
My automatic thought	2a. What is going through my mind right now? 2b. How much do I believe it, from 0 to 100%?
My emotion	3a. Believing that, what do I feel? 3b. How strong is it, from 0 to 100%?
My behaviour & body	4a. What do I do when I believe that and feel that way? 4b. What do I notice in my body?
The other person's mind	5. What might be going through the other person's mind when I behave that way?
The other person's feeling	6. What might they feel if they had that thought?
The other person's behaviour	7. And what might they do — which then feeds back to me?
Seeing the cycle	Step back and look at the whole exchange as one circular pattern: what does each of us do that keeps it going?
The part I can change	Which parts of the cycle are outside my control — and which part (my own behaviour) can I most influence?
Final check	8. Now that I can see the cycle, how much do I still believe my original thought (0–100%)? 9. How am I feeling overall now?
Action Plan	10. What do I plan to do? Then, in order: my actions, what might get in the way of each, how I could handle that, and when I'll try.